

 CRIMSON COVEN — Thousand Sons Warband

700 Credit Army Build | Trench Hammer

"We are Tzeentch's chosen instruments. In every bullet lies a prophecy. In every flame, the will of the Architect of Fate."

 Lore Foundation

The Thousand Sons are not simply Chaos worshippers — they were the most gifted psychic brotherhood in the galaxy, organized into sacred cults:

- **Pavoni** — Biomancy: shaping and regenerating flesh through Warp power
- **Raptora** — Telekinesis: bending physical reality, controlling gravity
- **Corvidae** — Divination: seeing through the flow of time, prophesying the future
- **Athanean** — Telepathy: linking minds, coordinating like a single unified machine
- **Pyrae** — Pyromancy: controlling fire, thoughts becoming hellstorms

Their tragedy was being *pushed* into heresy by ignorance and betrayal — not by inherently evil nature. Magnus the Red — the one-eyed crimson father — was scholar-warrior, the brightest star in the Imperium's sky. Even after the Rubricae curse, every action of the Thousand Sons remains a calculated deliberation: they do not fight with brute force — they **orchestrate** outcomes before the battle begins.

 Army Roster — LEGALLY VALID BUILD

#	Model	Wargear	Cost (cr)
1	Exalted Sorcerer (PSYKER 3, LEADER)	PA · Force Rod · Doombolt · Baleful Devolution · Telekine Dome	148
2	Tzaangor Shaman (PSYKER 1)	Force Rod · (built-in Baleful Dev) · Cacodaemonic Curse	68
3	Sekhetar Robot (VEHICLE, TOUGH)	Hellfyre Missile Rack (built-in) · Inferno Boltgun	185
4	Rubric Marine (Auto: Mark of Tzeentch)	Power Armour · Inferno Boltgun	120
5–8	×4 Tzaangors (SKIRMISHER, BEASTMEN)	Blade (each)	176
GRAND TOTAL			697 / 700 

 Full Credit Breakdown (Fully Transparent)

Exalted Sorcerer:

85 (base)
 + 40 (Power Armour – mandatory, not included in base)
 + 3 (Force Rod – mandatory PSYCHIC weapon; Psyker Only)
 + 10 (Doombolt – Discipline of Change)
 + 3 (Baleful Devolution – Discipline of Change)
 + 7 (Telekine Dome – Telekinesis Shared Discipline)
 = 148 cr

NOTE: Mark of Tzeentch = BAKED IN to base cost

Rule states "always equipped with a Mark of Tzeentch, included in its cost"
 NO additional +10 cr from Tzeentch Disciples applies here.

Tzaangor Shaman:

60 (base)
 + 3 (Force Rod – mandatory PSYCHIC weapon)
 + 5 (Cacodaemonic Curse – Discipline of Change)
 = 68 cr

NOTE: Baleful Devolution = built-in special ability, no purchase cost
 NOT subject to +10 Tzeentch Disciples (Shaman is its own unit type)

Sekhetar Robot:

170 (base – includes Hellfyre Missile Rack + armour plating)
 + 15 (Inferno Boltgun – Thousand Sons Battlekit)
 = 185 cr

Rubric Marine (= Chaos Space Marine):

55 (base CSM)
 + 40 (Power Armour – mandatory)
 + 10 (Mark of Tzeentch – Tzeentch Disciples automatically applies to all CSMs)
 + 15 (Inferno Boltgun – Thousand Sons Battlekit)
 = 120 cr

Tzaangor x4:

40 (base each)
 + 4 (Blade – Melee, CRITICAL)
 = 44 cr each × 4 = 176 cr

NOTE: NOT subject to +10 Tzeentch Disciples
 (only applies to: Chaos Sorcerers, Cultists, CSMs, Terminators, Helbrutes)

TOTAL: 148 + 68 + 185 + 120 + 176 = 697 cr ✓

Unit-by-Unit Analysis

1. ⚡ Exalted Sorcerer — "*Iksemet the Flame-Crowned*"

Role: Supreme Commander / Arcane Artillery / Psyker Linchpin

Stat	Value
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Stat	Value
Movement	6"/Infantry
Ranged Skill	+2
Melee Skill	+2
Armour	-2 (Power Armour)
Keywords	ELITE · LARGE · LEADER · PSYKER 3 · TOUGH · TZEENTCH

Wargear & Powers:

- **Force Rod** (Melee, +1 INJURY DICE vs DAEMON/PSYKER, PSYCHIC, HELD, MAIN HAND ONLY)
- **Doombolt** (Discipline of Change, 10 cr) — 24", +1 INJURY DICE, PSYCHIC, RISKY — primary damage power
- **Baleful Devolution** (Discipline of Change, 3 cr) — 12", One Enemy, Immediate: 1 STUN MARKER (D3 on Critical Success) — persistent STUN pressure
- **Telekine Dome** (Telekinesis Shared, 7 cr) — No Range, Self, End of Turn: -1 DICE to Hit against caster **and all allies within 3"** — protective bubble

Why this model wins games:

PSYKER 3 means **+3 DICE on every Cast roll**. Doombolt at +5 total DICE (PSYKER 3 using PSYCHIC stat in place of RS/MS, plus Ranged +2) hits virtually **every time**. Force Rod with the PSYCHIC keyword also benefits from PSYKER 3 — in melee against DAEMON or PSYKER, it adds +1 INJURY DICE, making it a blender against enemy psykers.

TOUGH means the first Down result on the Injury table becomes a Minor Hit. **Black Carapace** handles it the same way. Combined, Iksemet is *extraordinarily hard to kill* for his cost.

Telekine Dome turns him from a fragile glass cannon into a protected arcane fortress — position 1–2 Rubric Marines or Tzaangors within 3" and they all benefit from the -1 DICE bubble.

 **Importance: CRITICAL.** If Iksemet falls, the entire psychic machine collapses. Protect at all costs. Open each activation with Telekine Dome, then Doombolt the highest-priority Elite target in 24". Only enter melee against PSYKER or DAEMON targets where the Force Rod truly shines.

2. Tzaangor Shaman — "*Khentkaus the Sightless*"

Role: Psychic Support / Beast-Priest / Debuffer

Stat	Value
Movement	6"/Infantry
Ranged Skill	+1
Melee Skill	+1
Armour	0 (no armour)

Stat	Value
Keywords	BEASTMEN · ELITE · FOLLOWER · PSYKER 1 · TZEENTCH

Wargear & Powers:

- **Force Rod** (mandatory PSYCHIC weapon)
- **[Built-in] Baleful Devolution** — 12", One Enemy, Immediate: 1 STUN MARKER (D3 on Critical) — free, no additional Cast needed
- **Cacodaemonic Curse** (Change, 5 cr) — 24", One Enemy, Target Activation: that enemy has -1 INJURY DICE on **all their ranged attacks** through their next activation

Why this model is the backbone of the Tzaangor pack:

Bestial Prophet — Every BEASTMEN model within 6" of Khentkaus gains **+1 DICE to Hit with all attacks**. This single ability transforms 4 mediocre Tzaangors with +1 Melee into a genuinely threatening melee pack with the equivalent of +2 Melee — on a budget.

Baleful Devolution is a free harassment tool — **stack STUN MARKERS**. When an enemy accumulates 6 STUN MARKERS, when they activate, spend all 6 to **Stunlock**: they fall Down and their **Activation ends immediately**. This completely denies a dangerous melee Elite their turn without a single attack roll.

Cacodaemonic Curse is precision debuffing — neuter the enemy's best ranged fighter for an entire round. Pair this with Hathor-Setep's dual fire to make the enemy almost unable to respond in that window.

Sacrificial Blessing — dark but powerful: *sacrifice a nearby Tzaangor* to gain **+2 DICE** on a critical Cast roll. When you need to guarantee Stunlock an enemy threat at exactly the right moment, this is the clutch play.

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Critical Weakness: Armour 0. Khentkaus dies to 1–2 direct hits. Always keep him behind a Tzaangor screen. Never let him be charged.
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Importance: HIGH. Without him, the 4 Tzaangors lose their Hit bonus and the entire STUN MARKER engine vanishes. The warband loses roughly 30% of its total effectiveness.

3. 🤖 Sekhetar Robot — "*Hathor-Setep the Prophetic Sentinel*"

Role: Heavy Fire Support / The Tank / Stealthy Vanguard

Stat	Value
Movement	6"/Infantry
Ranged Skill	+1
Melee Skill	+1
Armour	-2
Keywords	ARTIFICIAL · INFILTRATOR · NEGATE GAS · STEALTH · STRONG · TOUGH · VEHICLE · TZEENTCH

Wargear:

- **Hellfyre Missile Rack** (built-in: 36", IGNORE COVER, FIRE) — constant long-range fire harassment
- **Inferno Boltgun** (15 cr: 24", VICIOUS 11, AP1 on Critical Hit, CRITICAL, TWO-HANDED) — precision fire against armoured targets

Why this is the warband's tank:

The Sekhetar Robot is *purpose-built* for this role:

Keyword	Practical Effect
TOUGH	First Down result on Injury table → Minor Hit; extremely hard to kill
VEHICLE	Higher effective resilience thresholds vs standard infantry
STRONG	Carries heavy gear without penalty
INFILTRATOR	Deploys within 12" of the enemy deployment edge — skips the open-ground crossing problem entirely
STEALTH	Enemies cannot target it at range until they are close enough (Photo Goggles trick doesn't work against this)
NEGATE GAS	Completely immune to gas weapons and toxins

Robotic Armaments: With Hellfyre Rack + Inferno Boltgun, the Robot fires **both** in a single Shoot action. Two weapon attacks per activation from a STEALTH INFILTRATOR is exceptional.

Prophetic Sentinel: When an enemy Charges the Robot, it fires the Inferno Boltgun at them *before they move*. VICIOUS 11 (additional effect on a roll of 11+) + CRITICAL means every attempt to engage this model in melee is extremely punishing for the attacker.

Mark of Tzeentch (+1 INJURY MODIFIER to all ranged attacks): Hellfyre Rack's FIRE shots gain +1 INJURY MODIFIER. Against unarmoured infantry, a single activation can delete a model entirely.

 **Importance: CRITICAL.** Hathor-Setep establishes a forward position via INFILTRATOR, forcing the enemy to deal with it from Turn 1 or suffer dual fires every round. STEALTH makes it hard to target from range. This model buys the rest of the warband 2–3 turns of undisturbed psychic setup time.

4. 🦴 Rubric Marine — "*The Nameless Dust*"

Role: Durable Mid-Field Gunner / Psychic Unit Anchor

Stat	Value
Movement	5"/Infantry (Rubric Marines special rule)
Ranged Skill	+2
Melee Skill	+2
Armour	–2 (Power Armour)

Stat	Value
Keywords	HERETIC ASTARTES · TZEENTCH · NEGATE GAS

Wargear:

- **Power Armour** (mandatory; Mark of Tzeentch auto-applied +10 cr via Tzeentch Disciples)
- **Inferno Boltgun** (24", VICIOUS 11, AP1 on Critical Hit, CRITICAL, TWO-HANDED)

Key rules:

- **Black Carapace** — first Down result on Injury table → Minor Hit; extremely durable
- **Rubric Marines rule** — When activated within 6" of a PSYKER, gains **+1 DICE to all Dash actions** — can reposition aggressively when needed
- **Mark of Tzeentch (auto)** — Inferno Boltgun gains **+1 INJURY MODIFIER** on all shots
- **NEGATE GAS** — fully immune to gas weapons

Combat effectiveness:

Inferno Boltgun + Mark of Tzeentch = 24", VICIOUS 11, AP1 on Critical, +1 INJURY MODIFIER. Against Power Armour (−2): a Critical Hit (roll 11+) applies AP1, reducing the armour penalty to −1, combined with +1 INJURY MODIFIER — a genuinely dangerous shot even against heavily armoured targets.

This model is the iconic image of the lore Thousand Sons: the bronze-armoured automaton advancing forward under arcane direction from the Sorcerer behind it. The pairing of the Exalted Sorcerer + Rubric Marine is the spiritual heart of this warband.

 **Importance: MEDIUM-HIGH.** The 5" speed means it often lags behind faster scenarios. Keep it within 6" of the Exalted Sorcerer for the Dash bonus. It is a durable, patient gunner — very difficult to kill, and when in position, fires with excellent effect.

5–8. □ Tzaangors ×4 — "*Servants of Change*"

Role: Melee Screen / Objective Holders / Sacrificial Pawns

Stat	Value
Movement	6"/Infantry
Ranged Skill	+1
Melee Skill	+1
Armour	0
Keywords	BEASTMEN · FOLLOWER · SKIRMISHER · TZEENTCH · LIMITED POTENTIAL

Wargear: Blade (Melee, CRITICAL)

The combined power package:

- **+1 DICE to Hit** from Shaman's Bestial Prophet = effectively equivalent to Melee Skill +2 when near Khentkaus
- **SKIRMISHER** = free movement and excellent terrain exploitation
- **Blade (CRITICAL)** = on a melee roll of 11+, +1 INJURY DICE bonus — surprisingly lethal for just 44 credits
- **Sacrificial Blessing** = if needed, sacrifice a wounded Tzaangor to give the Shaman a guaranteed critical Cast

Why exactly four at 44 credits each:

Four Tzaangors create **board presence** that forces the enemy to commit resources to clearing them — during which time the Exalted Sorcerer and Shaman complete their arcane ritual undisturbed. Every Tzaangor that survives another turn is another Cast action, another STUN MARKER, another opportunity for Hathor-Setep to fire twice.

 **Importance: FOUNDATIONAL.** Without them, the Exalted Sorcerer and Shaman are nakedly exposed to every melee threat on the board. They are cheap, adequately fast, dangerous enough to demand attention, and expendable when needed.

Tactics & Playstyle

Philosophy: **The Warp is the Weapon**

This warband plays exactly as the Thousand Sons operate in the lore — *deliberate, arcane, controlled*. The Exalted Sorcerer is the eye of the storm. The Shaman agitates the edges. The Robot is fate's iron fist. The Rubric Marine is patient death. The Tzaangors are the tide of change.

Core Activation Sequence

TURN 1:

[1] Activate EXALTED SORCERER:

- Cast Telekine Dome (protect self + allies within 3")
- Cast Doombolt at the most dangerous Elite target within 24"

[2] Activate SEKHETAR ROBOT (already deployed via INFILTRATOR):

- Shoot Hellfyre Rack + Inferno Boltgun simultaneously
- Prophetic Sentinel: if Charged, fire Inferno Boltgun before attacker moves

[3] Activate TZAANGOR SHAMAN:

- Cast Baleful Devolution at the most dangerous melee threat
- Cast Cacodaemonic Curse at the enemy's best ranged fighter

[4] Advance TZAANGORS toward objectives and the enemy infantry line

[5] Advance RUBRIC MARINE to firing position (keep within 6" of Sorcerer)

Mid-Battle — *Crescendo of the Warp*

The real power emerges in Turns 2–3 when the pieces combine:

The Stunlock Combo:

Turn 1: Baleful Devolution → 1 STUN MARKER on the target
Turn 2: Baleful Devolution Critical → D3 STUN MARKERS (average 2)
Turn 3: Accumulated 6 STUN MARKERS
→ When the target activates, spend all 6
→ They fall Down and their ACTIVATION ENDS IMMEDIATELY
→ An enemy Elite melee fighter has been completely neutralized without a single weapon attack being rolled

The Sorcerer's Protective Bubble:

- *Telekine Dome* recast every activation = the 3" cluster around the Sorcerer imposes –1 DICE on all attackers
- Even when enemies close in, melee against –2 Armour + –1 DICE (Dome) + TOUGH + Black Carapace = the Sorcerer absorbs punishment that would destroy any other model

The Strategic Sacrifice: When a critical Cast must land to stop an enemy charge at a crucial moment — sacrifice a wounded Tzaangor. The Shaman gains +2 DICE → near-guaranteed Critical Success → D3 STUN MARKERS → Stunlock. The pawn's death saves the game.



Matchup Guide

Enemy Type	Approach
Heavy Melee (World Eaters, Khorne)	Tzaangor screen + relentless STUN spam. Doombolt their leader in Turn 1.
Ranged / Infiltrators	Hathor-Setep deploys forward via INFILTRATOR to contest their setup zone. <i>Cacodaemonic Curse</i> cuts their best gun's damage output.
Enemy Psykers	Exalted Sorcerer attempts to Deny the Witch at PSYKER 3 (+3 DICE) — matching or beating the opponent's roll cancels their power entirely.
Armoured Elites	Doombolt (+1 INJURY DICE, PSYCHIC roll essentially bypasses standard armour mitigation), Force Rod in melee, Inferno Boltgun AP1 on Critical.
Hordes / Light Followers	Hellfyre Rack (FIRE, IGNORE COVER) sweeps light infantry; STUN stacking locks down individual dangerous models.

 Campaign Progression

The Thousand Sons have their own campaign mechanic — **Discover the Arcane** (collecting Arcane Points from Arcana markers placed by your opponent):

Arcane Points	Reward
5–9 points	<i>Text of Warp-Blown Ash</i> — once per battle, ignore Perils of the Warp entirely. Absolutely critical when a PSYKER 3 casts multiple times per turn.
10–14 points	<i>Visions of Doom</i> — the targeted enemy suffers –1 DICE to all Success Rolls and Injury rolls against them have +1 INJURY DICE for the entire Turn. Devastating.
15+ points	<i>Binding Flames</i> — approaching near-invincibility for the caster.

First Promotion (a Tzaangor or Rubric Marine reaching Elite): via *Aspiring Sorcerers*, they gain **PSYKER 1** and choose a discipline. A Rubric Marine with *Warptime* (ally gains +1 DICE to Hit) is a significant overall power increase for the entire warband.

Strengths vs Weaknesses

Strengths	Weaknesses
✓ Three active Psykers — relentless psychic pressure	✗ Low model count — vulnerable to Morale crisis if 2–3 models fall early
✓ Stunlock combo completely neutralizes key enemy units	✗ Tzaangor Shaman is extremely fragile (Armour 0)
✓ Sekhetar Robot is near-unkillable (TOUGH + VEHICLE + –2)	✗ No Deny-the-Witch coverage beyond the Exalted Sorcerer
✓ Mark of Tzeentch upgrades all ranged attacks	✗ No massed firepower — only 1 Inferno Boltgun + the Robot
✓ TOUGH on 2 models (Exalted + Robot) — very resilient core	✗ Rubric Marine's 5" speed struggles in fast-movement scenarios
✓ INFILTRATOR + STEALTH forces enemy to react immediately	✗ Tzaangors at Armour 0 cannot absorb sustained fire

Conclusion

The spirit of Magnus the Red lives in this list. You do not win through brute force — you win by **reading the board** (Divination), **controlling the flow** (Stunlock/Stun Markers), **protecting your assets** (Telekine Dome), and **striking with precision** (Doombolt). The Thousand Sons do not fight battles. They *conclude* them.

FINAL CREDIT SUMMARY:		
Exalted Sorcerer		148 cr
Tzaangor Shaman		68 cr
Sekhetar Robot		185 cr
Rubric Marine		120 cr

4× Tzaangor		176 cr	
TOTAL		697 / 700 cr	✓
Model Count		8 models	
Glory Spent		0 Glory	✓

"All is dust... and from dust, the galaxy is remade."
— Magnus the Red, before Prospero burned